

WOMEN IN GAMING

Girl and women gamers on India's video game industry

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hen you think about video games, it brings a cliched vision to mind about how it's just a boys' club – right from the people who make the games all the way down to the players who play their video games. It wasn't untrue, at least for kids growing up in the 1980s and 90s, including yours truly. But circa 2023, the gaming paradigm is vastly different. Not only are there more girl gamers than ever before, not just in India but around the world, women have been making slow but steady progress in getting their numbers up across the gaming industry as a whole. As they rightly should, of course!

The present state of women gamers in the country is promising. In this feature, we've tried to go beyond published reports and provide insights and information from a variety of girls and women in Indian gaming – from senior women in leadership positions inside gaming companies based in India to female members of SKOAR! College Gaming Club. What are some of their experiences, good and bad, from the gaming industry, and what are some of their hopes and aspirations. We've done this to acknowledge their voice and contributions to the proliferation of gaming in India. Without further ado, here's what the pioneering girl gamers from India have to say.



IMAGING: ANIL VK